

SPEAKER KIT · 2026

# Sahara Al-Madi

Computational linguist · AI security and governance · Founder,  
Linguistic Security Institute

*Language is inheritance for communities,  
infrastructure for policy, and evidence for  
science. Systems should serve all three.*



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## ABOUT

A linguist building systems that are secure, accountable, and educational for the communities they serve.

Sahara founded the Linguistic Security Institute, an open-source research initiative built on one principle: AI systems must be accountable to the communities whose languages they process.

ACL 2026 published

7 engagements in 2026

English · Spanish · Italian · Arabic · Low resource language research



## LINGUISTIC SECURITY

The principle that AI systems must be accountable to the communities whose languages they process.

It asks not only whether a system works, but for whom it works, whom it fails, and who gets to decide.



## THREE PILLARS

# What we hold AI systems to

01

### Data sovereignty

**Who controls the language data, and who benefits?**

Communities consent to how their languages are represented and share in the value they create.

02

### Transparency

**Which languages are included, which are missing, and how does each fare?**

Per-language reporting is required, as each language presents distinct needs & outcomes.

03

### Social value

**Does the system serve the community, or extract from it?**

Accuracy alone is not enough if outputs cause harm.

*Language is both a community's inheritance and a system's attack surface.*



## SIGNATURE TALKS

# Four talks, tailored to each audience

### SECURITY · RED TEAMS

## Polyglot Poisoning: Hunting Linguistic Attacks in AI

Testing AI guardrails across dialects, writing systems, and code-switching, with a live red-team demonstration.

### POLICY · GEOSCIENCE

## Who Speaks for the Data?

Exploring parallels between language, AI ethics and the governance of non-human data across space and conservation contexts.

### EDUCATORS · LANGUAGE PROGRAMS

## To Listen is to Inherit

How human traditions of listening and carrying memory shape our expectations of what language systems should remember, retain, and carry forward.

### SPACE POLICY · ETHICS

## Seven Generations in Orbit

Space debris and orbital decisions are treated as relational matters, shaped through deliberation.

Delivered in English or Spanish · virtual, in person or hybrid · custom topics welcome



## FORMATS

# From a keynote to a hands-on lab

Every session ends with something the audience can use: a framework to apply, a tool to run, or a question to take back to their own systems.

|                                 |           |
|---------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Keynote</b>                  | 30–60 min |
| <b>Conference talk or panel</b> | 20–45 min |
| <b>Hands-on workshop</b>        | 2–4 hours |
| <b>Guest lecture or seminar</b> | 50–90 min |
| <b>Assessment and advisory</b>  | Scoped    |



LIVE DEMOS

# Talks come with working tools

AI SECURITY · BSIDES SAN DIEGO 2026

## Linguistic Firewall: Polyglot Poisoning

Probes LLM guardrails with dialects, scripts and code-switching. Basis for the DEATHCon 2026 workshop.

[github.com/LinguisticSecurityInstitute/linguistic-firewall](https://github.com/LinguisticSecurityInstitute/linguistic-firewall)

YOHAKU HACKATHON · CHALLENGE 2

## Seven Generations in Orbit

A decision tool for space-debris responsibility, built on seven questions grounded in Lakota principles.

[almadilsitask2yohaku.kimi.page](https://almadilsitask2yohaku.kimi.page)

<https://github.com/LinguisticSecurityInstitute/YOHAKU2026>



2026 ENGAGEMENTS

# Seven stages across five fields

| DATE   | EVENT                                   | AUDIENCE                            | FORMAT    |
|--------|-----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|-----------|
| Jan 24 | Tech Intersections, Northeastern        | Equity in cybersecurity             | In person |
| Mar 16 | GEO Indigenous Summit                   | Earth observationPolicy             | Virtual   |
| Apr 4  | BSides San Diego                        | Cybersecurity                       | In person |
| Oct 9  | YOHAKU Space Global Showcase            | Earth observationSpace DebrisPolicy | Virtual   |
| Oct 11 | GSA Connects 2026, Denver               | GeosciencePolicy                    | In person |
| Oct 16 | Technology for Second Language Learning | Language education                  | Virtual   |
| Nov 14 | DEATHCon / BSides San Diego             | Cybersecurity                       | Hybrid    |



## RESEARCH

# Peer-reviewed work behind the talks

ACL 2026 · SEMEVAL TASK 9 · PUBLISHED JULY 3, 2026

## **NAMAA at SemEval-2026 Task 9: Comparing Generative, Retrieval-Augmented, and Discriminative Methods for Arabic Online Polarization Detection**

Error analysis lead across 10+ LLMs: dialectal bias, hallucinations and gold-label inconsistencies.

ARABIC NLP @ EMNLP 2026 · BAREC · PUBLISHED OCTOBER 28, 2026

## **LSI at BAREC Shared Task 2026: Training Convergence, Heuristics, and Ensembles for Arabic Sentence-Level Readability**

Solo author. Ranked 1st in the Constrained Track, 3rd in Open Track



WORKING TOGETHER

# Open by default, sustainable by design

## Open Source

### Free

Community, Indigenous and language organizations, student groups, open-source projects.

Open tools and materials, recorded talks, virtual community sessions as availability allows.

## Professional

### Fee on request

Conferences, universities, companies, professional associations.

Tailored keynotes and talks, hands-on workshops with lab materials, planning call and attendee resources.

## Partner

### Custom scope

Teams deploying multilingual AI, public sector, foundations.

Linguistic security assessments, training series, governance advisory, research collaboration.

Paid engagements help sustain LSI's open-source work and keep the community tier available.





# Bring linguistic security to your stage

Share your audience, dates and goals through the inquiry form. For in-person events, 6–8 weeks' notice is ideal.

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